

---

# SEWANG

SEWANG CORPORATION

---

## Market Insight Report · 2026 June, Week 3 (6/15 – 6/21)

Published 2026-06-16 · For distribution to partners · © Sewang Corp.

Listening Bar Trend

The Second-Round "Slow One"

New Venue Type

---

Publisher Sewang Corp. | CEO Jung Min-sung (msjung75@gmail.com) | HQ +82-2-2203-5311

**This Issue** From Tokyo to Seoul — the "Listening Bar" arrives: a new kind of drinking occasion built on time spent with music

# CONTENTS

## Overview & Summary

### 01 Trend Diagnosis — What a "Listening Bar" Is, and Why It Spread from Tokyo

The 100-year revival of the ongaku kissa; a generation choosing bars over clubs

### 02 Why Korea, Why Now — Three Tailwinds

Shifting second-round culture · vinyl revival · lower tax on low-ABV drinks

### 03 Tokyo Field Notes — Ginza Music Bar · Shibuya Record Bar

Drinks, prices and menus of two Tokyo listening bars seen first-hand

### 04 Seoul Listening-Bar Map — Five Already Here

Jongno · Euljiro · Haebangchon · Apgujeong · Hannam — real venues by district

### 05 The Drinks a Listening Bar Calls For — Small-Batch Premium

Craft beer · whisky highball · natural wine · premium sake

### 06 Channel Strategy — New Bars / Music-Paired Dining / Vinyl Pubs

Tailored proposals by channel + direct lines to your account manager

### 07 Maximizing Venue Sales — Six Proposals for Listening Bars

Sound + pairing · signature highball · LP nights · non-alcoholic option

### 08 About Sewang & Contacts for 13 Sales Managers

Full-line liquor wholesale for Seoul/Gyeonggi · direct lines by district

#### This Issue in One Sentence

▲ New Venue Type

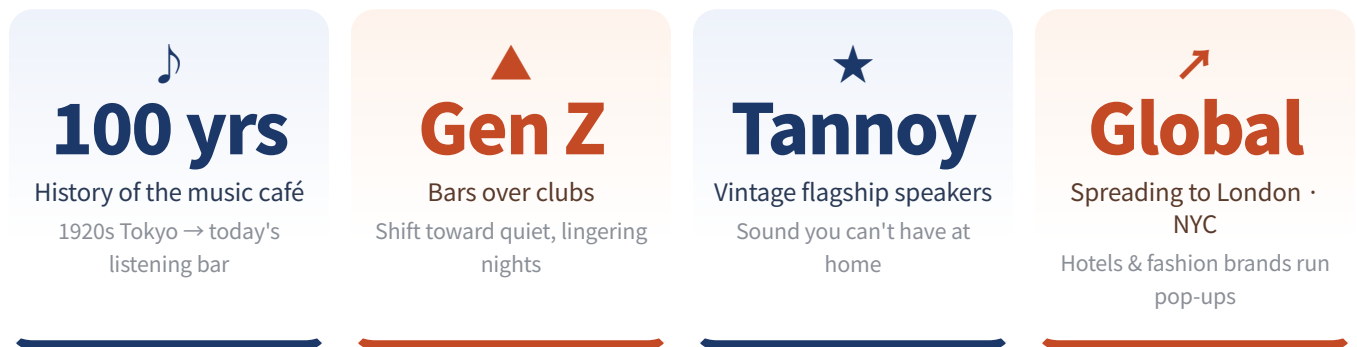
"Drink hard and fast" is fading; **drinking occasions built on slowly spending time with music** are rising. Proven in Tokyo, the **listening bar** is a second-round venue calling for "a light, good single drink" — for Sewang, an opportunity to win new accounts with a bundle of **craft beer, highball, natural wine and sake**.

# What a "Listening Bar" Is, and Why It Spread from Tokyo

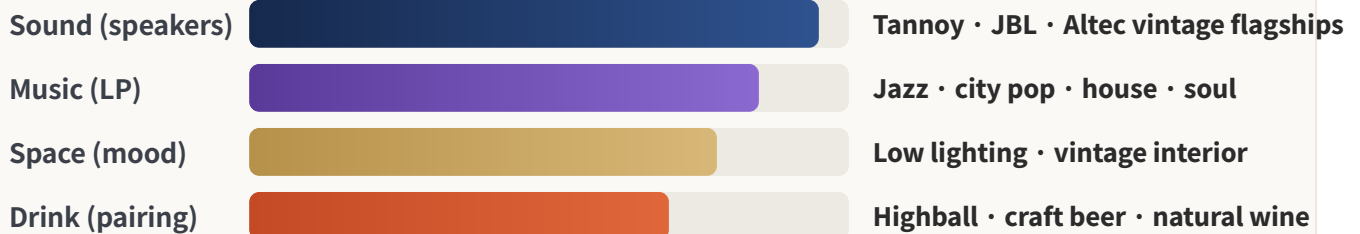
A bar where you "listen" to music on high-end speakers. Japan's 100-year-old ongaku kissa (music café) has returned in sleek interiors as Gen Z night culture.

## One-line definition — a place you go to "listen," not just to "drink"

A listening bar is a venue where **music is the main act**, played through vintage speakers and LPs on a turntable. The opposite of a loud club — good sound, low lighting and a single drink make it an **"immersive music space."**



### The four elements of a listening bar



Bar lengths illustrate the relative weight of each element in the concept. The point: sound and music lead, while drinks extend the time guests stay.

#### KEY

Tokyo landmarks like **Bar Martha (Ebisu)** and **Studio Mule (Shibuya)** have become audiophile pilgrimage sites, and in 2025 even a **mobile listening bar** — a classic Mini towing a "listening room" — appeared. Global brands such as Valentino and Virgin Hotels borrow the format for pop-ups, a sign of how **proven** the trend is.

Sources: Smithsonian Magazine "Why Gen Z Is Trading Night Clubs for Listening Bars" · The World (PRX) "Japan's listening lounges" 2025-02 · Corner · PUNCH "Tokyo listening bars" · Citizen Femme 2025-04 · ※ Some content is interpretive, based on press coverage.

# Why Korea, Why Now — Three Tailwinds

Korea already has the soil for listening bars to take root. Changing drinking culture, the vinyl revival and tax policy all line up at once.

## SHIFT IN CONSUMPTION

**Binge** ↓  
**Taste** ↑

Drinking frequency and volume fall, but the grain of consumption shifts to "less, but better, and slower."

①

**Changing second-round culture** — fewer hard-drinking after-parties; more lingering "one more, lightly" after dinner

②

**Vinyl revival** — an LP boom led by people in their 20s–30s; LP bars spreading in Seochon, Haebangchon, Seongsu

③

**Lower tax on low-ABV drinks** — a policy tailwind for highballs and craft beer (see below)

## Market currents supporting listening bars

Whisky · highball



"Highball bar" now an established category ▲

Japanese beer



No. 1 imported beer 3 years running ▲

Craft beer



Recovery expected from tax cut ▲

Natural wine



Pairs with vinyl bars & dining ▲

LP · vinyl



20s–30s revival continues ▲

※ Categories use different sources and bases — bars show direction of growth, not absolute comparison.

## POLICY

The government will **cut the liquor tax by 30%** on a temporary basis **from April 2026 through end-2028** for drinks of 8.5% ABV or less (with  $\geq 2$  non-volatile content). Highballs and craft beer — **the core menu of a listening bar — benefit directly.**

Sources: Kuki News "Lighter liquor consumption" 2026-02-19 · Daum/News "Highball tax cut ... craft beer" 2026-01-21 · Hankook Ilbo "Gen MZ LP boom" · Hankyung · Sommelier Times Japanese-beer / craft-beer coverage · ※ Policy and figures may vary by time.

# Ginza Music Bar · Shibuya Record Bar

Two Tokyo listening bars seen first-hand by our CEO. Drinks, price ranges and menus are transcribed exactly, so you can apply them to a Seoul venue right away.



## GINZA MUSIC BAR

**Address** Chuo City Ginza 7-8-13, Brown Place  
4F

**Price** ¥2,000 –  
7,000

**Drinks** TPM · Yona Yona Ale · craft  
beer

**Menu** Small plates · bar snacks · cheese  
platters

**INSIGHT** A flagship LP/vinyl listening bar · Famous for Tannoy speakers · High photo/branding value · Well known to foreign visitors · Classic Tokyo nightlife mood



## SHIBUYA RECORD BAR ANALOG

**Address** Realize Building 3F, 2-20-9 Dogenzaka,  
Shibuya-ku

**Price** ¥2,000 –  
3,000

**Drinks** Asahi · Japanese craft  
beer

**Menu** Small plates · bar snacks · finger  
food

**INSIGHT** A signature Shibuya record-bar culture space · LP-centered, immersive music experience · Dark lighting, vintage interior · Music-fashion-lifestyle blend · City pop, jazz, house · **Tokyo Gen-MZ listening-bar mood**

### How to read it — what both venues share

▲ ¥2,000+ per head

Both lay down **craft beer as the base line** and, with cover charges included, build a spend of **over ¥2,000 per guest**. The revenue driver isn't expensive food but "**great music + one or two good beers**" — a model that delivers high per-head spend even with few seats.

Sources: CEO-provided Tokyo field material (two listening bars, Ginza & Shibuya) · venue signage / Google Maps. Prices and menus may change from the time of visit.

# Seoul Listening-Bar Map — Five Already Here

Listening bars aren't a distant idea. Real venues are already established in Jongno, Euljiro, Haebangchon, Apgujeong and Hannam. (Addresses verified via Naver Local.)

## Soulville Listening Bar Jongno · Seochon

19-11 Sajik-ro 12-gil, Jongno-gu, Seoul, 1F

A true music-listening bar with "listening bar" in its name. **Soul/funk LPs** keep guests lingering — a good fit for **craft beer and highball** turnover.

## Pyeonggyunyul (PKY) Euljiro · Chungmuro

3 Chungmu-ro 4-gil, Jung-gu, Seoul (Oldies Taco bldg, 2F)

A signature Euljiro music bar — "no one goes only once." A music-led space that suits **small-batch premium curation**.

## SEOUL VINYL Haebangchon

30 Sinheung-ro, Yongsan-gu, Seoul, 1F

An LP bar and record shop in one. A vinyl-lovers' landmark with **high recognition among foreign visitors**. Strong potential for natural wine and craft beer pairings.

## Cotton Club Apgujeong Rodeo Apgujeong

14 Apgujeong-ro 54-gil, Gangnam-gu, Seoul, B1

A jazz/LP-mood music bar in Gangnam. A district where premium pricing holds — ideal for **whisky and premium sake** curation.

## Sounds Hannam (listening space) Hannam

35 Daesagwan-ro, Yongsan-gu, Seoul

Listening and music content inside a cultural complex. Combined with dining and lounges, it's a district with strong demand for **natural wine, mocktails and non-alcoholic** pairings.

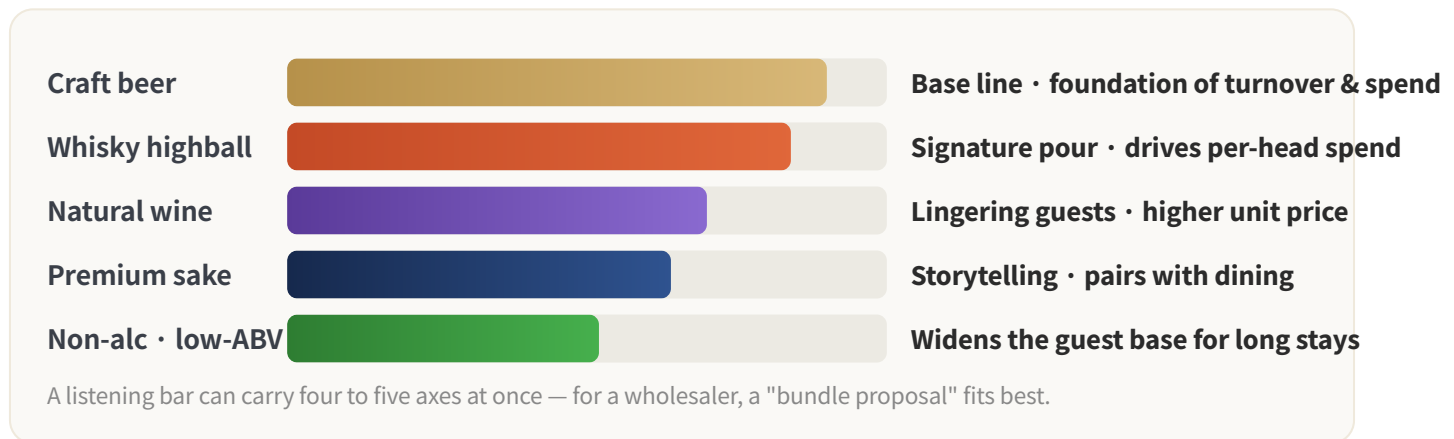
Sources: Naver Local (place search) verified for address/business type (2026-06-16) · press LP-bar / music-bar features. Hours and concepts may change — confirm before visiting.

# The Drinks a Listening Bar Calls For — Small-Batch Premium

A listening bar's drinks are about "doing it right," not "drinking a lot." One or two drinks that extend the stay — exactly what Sewang supplies best.



## A listening bar's drink lineup — four axes



### Sewang's proposal — a listening-bar bundle

▲ Hold the price

① **Craft & Japanese-beer base line** — Asahi, Suntory, Yona Yona for baseline sales · ② **Signature highball kit** (whisky + tonic + glass) to lift per-head spend · ③ **Natural wine & premium sake** curated small-batch with tasting notes · ④ **Bottled non-alcoholic** for the longest-staying guests. Sewang supplies it all in one bundle.

Sources: Hankyung · Sommelier Times Japanese-beer share coverage · Daum "Highball tax cut" 2026-01-21 · Asia Economy · Kuki News whisky/highball coverage · ※ Figures are estimates from press/customs and may vary by time.

# Channel Strategy

Tailored proposals by channel — new listening/music bars / music-paired dining & izakaya / vinyl pubs & wine bars + direct lines to your manager.

## CHANNEL 01



### New Listening / Music Bars — "Find the Venue"

The biggest opportunity. A newly opening listening/music bar is **a new venue type with no incumbent supplier**. Set up the craft, highball and natural-wine lines together at opening, and you become the long-term account. **Manager Hwang Hyun-woong finds new venues via SNS and local search.**

**Sewang proposal** — an opening package (base beers + highball kit + wine/sake curation), set up in one go (Contacts: Mgr. Hwang Hyun-woong / EVP Park Jung-eon)

## CHANNEL 02



### Music-Paired Dining & Izakaya — "Add a Corner"

Existing accounts can capture the after-dinner second round simply by **adding "a music corner."** One good speaker plus a **signature highball / sake pairing** raises both dwell time and per-head spend — making up for fewer guests with longer stays.

**Sewang proposal** — a highball kit + premium sake/Japanese-beer package to build a second-round menu (Contacts: EVP Lim Chang-soo / Dir. Chae Hyun-yong & Kim Hwan)

## CHANNEL 03



### Vinyl Pubs & Wine Bars — "Differentiate with Natural"

Vinyl pubs and wine bars in Haebangchon, Seongsu and Hannam run on **natural wine and craft beer**. Build regulars with **small-batch curation** matched to the music. In summer, light lagers and natural sparkling lift turnover.

**Sewang proposal** — natural wine + craft beer seasonal curation + a pairing guide (Contacts: SVP Son Seung-il / Vice-Chairman Lee Han-woo)

## OUR PROMISE

The channels differ, the point is the same — **a listening bar isn't where you "sell a lot," it's where you "sell good things, slowly."** Sewang is not just a supplier but a partner in product, menu and promotion. New-venue intel and SNS trends are provided by GM Seong Hyun-woo.

Sources: this report's PART 01–05 analysis + Sewang's channel-level account data. Manager territory assignments may change — call HQ (+82-2-2203-5311) for first guidance.



# Maximizing Venue Sales — Six Proposals for Listening Bars

Six ways to grow sales at listening bars and music-paired venues. Sewang executes alongside you with product, kits and consulting.

1

## Sound + pairing as one set

Put a **signature pairing** matched to the music on the menu. "For this LP, this highball" curation lifts both dwell time and per-head spend.

Pairing menu

Signature

2

## Signature highball kit

Whisky + tonic + glass as a **kit** = an instant signature highball. The tax cut sharpens price competitiveness. Sewang supplies the kit.

Kakubin

Glassware

Tax cut

3

## Craft & Japanese-beer base line

Asahi, Suntory, Yona Yona as a **base line** for baseline sales — the most reliable turnover items for a listening bar.

Asahi

Craft

4

## Natural wine & sake curation

Small-batch **natural wine and premium sake** with a story raise the unit price of lingering guests.

Natural wine

Premium sake

5

## LP nights & guest events

DJ/selector guest days create **buzz and footfall**. Sewang supports events with season-limited drinks.

LP night

Limited drinks

6

## Non-alcoholic to widen the base

The longer guests stay, the more **bottled non-alcoholic** captures drivers, daytime and health-minded guests. Sewang supplies the bottled line.

Bottled non-alc

Wider base

## Our promise — we grow sales together

[▲ Grow together](#)

A listening bar is a venue for "**lingering long over one good drink.**" Sales come from curation, pairing and events — not volume. Sewang will be with you to the end through **product, kits, consulting and promotion** — that's how venues and Sewang grow together in a shrinking market.

# About Sewang & Sales Manager Contacts

From hotels to restaurants across Seoul & Gyeonggi — your full-line liquor wholesale partner · founded 1978 · a 13-person sales team.

## Sewang Corp.

Full-line liquor distribution to hotels, restaurants and bars in Seoul/Gyeonggi · founded 1978 · this report is for distribution to partners

### CHANNELS

Hotels · fine dining · Korean bars · izakaya · listening/music bars · pojangmacha · lounge bars

### CATEGORIES

Beer (Hite Jinro · OB · Lotte) · craft & import beer · non-alcoholic · whisky · wine & natural wine · sake · makgeolli · soju · traditional spirits

### SERVICES

Weekly market report · new-venue scouting · partner SNS intelligence · new-product promotion/launch support · pairing consulting

### MAIN LINE

# 02-2203-5311

60 Jinhwangdo-ro 61-gil, Gangdong-gu, Seoul ·  
100 m from Bohun Hospital Stn. (Line 9), Exit 1  
Web [www.sewang.co.kr](http://www.sewang.co.kr) · Email  
[msjung75@gmail.com](mailto:msjung75@gmail.com) · CEO Jung Min-sung

| Title             | Name             | Direct (010)  | Territory / Notes                                       |
|-------------------|------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Vice Pres.</b> | Lee Han-woo      | 010-5210-5449 | Sales lead — hotel & fine-dining channel                |
| <b>EVP</b>        | Lim Chang-soo    | 010-3742-3054 | Seoul Gangnam<br>(Gangnam · Yeoksam · Nonhyeon · Sinsa) |
| <b>EVP</b>        | Park Jung-eon    | 010-3286-9489 | Sales GM · report publishing lead                       |
| <b>SVP</b>        | Son Seung-il     | 010-7539-3535 | Seoul Yongsan · Hannam · Itaewon · Samgakji             |
| <b>Director</b>   | Lee Won-cheol    | 010-3354-2101 | Seoul Gangbuk · Jongno · Jung-gu                        |
| <b>Director</b>   | Chae Hyun-yong   | 010-8889-3057 | Seoul Seongdong · Seongsu · Wangsimni                   |
| <b>Director</b>   | Kim Hwan         | 010-4789-3282 | Seoul Mapo · Seodaemun · Yeonnam · Hongdae              |
| <b>Director</b>   | Oh Gun-hoon      | 010-3495-6515 | Seoul Songpa · Gangdong · Jamsil                        |
| <b>Director</b>   | Shin Hong-cheol  | 010-9259-6474 | Gyeonggi Gwanggyo · Suwon · Bundang · Pangyo            |
| <b>GM</b>         | Bae Jong-hwan    | 010-9209-6526 | Seoul Gangseo · Magok · Balsan · Yeouido                |
| <b>GM</b>         | Yoo Kwang-seok   | 010-4565-6039 | Gyeonggi Hanam · Misa · Guri · Namyangju                |
| <b>GM</b>         | Seong Hyun-woo   | 010-3375-3646 | Seoul Yeongdeungpo · Guro · Yangcheon · Dongjak         |
| <b>Manager</b>    | Hwang Hyun-woong | 010-9123-4341 | Seoul/Gyeonggi new-account scouting (SNS · local)       |